May 14, 2026

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People often ask me what a Vice President of Influence does. Mostly, it's relationships. My job is to make connections that lead to meaningful conversations and collaborations with funders, nonprofits, and organizations that advocate for the sector. It's a great job.

At Candid, we help nonprofits tell their story, offering pathways to funders who share their objectives and values. And like any relationship, those connections require thoughtfulness and care.

My colleague Cat Clerkin and I will be digging into this on LinkedIn Live on Wednesday, May 20. I'll share how I approach relationship building with Candid's funders—what's worked, what hasn't, and what I've learned. Cat will bring the data on what we know about grantmaker funding across the sector. I hope you'll join us.



Aleda Gagarin
Vice President of Influence, Candid

Setting the record straight on nonprofit funding

Consider this: a donor searches for your financial statements, and all they find is information that's two years old. They become suspicious about your funding, and wonder if you're hiding something.

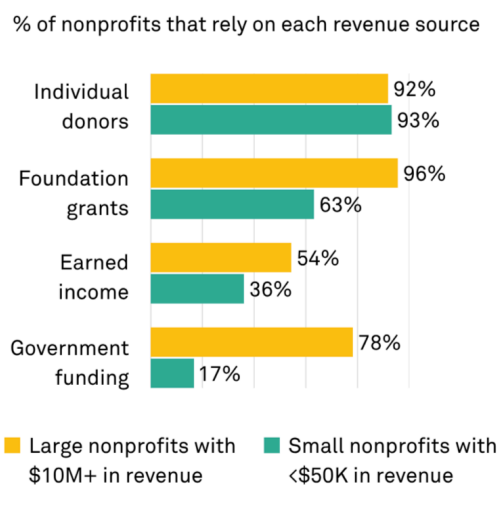
What they don't know is that the IRS takes up to two years to release that information. Yet, when people can't find real-time information, they fill in the gaps with their own story.

You can push back against these misconceptions. Post your nonprofit's most recent financials and educate your supporters on how to find trustworthy information about your work.

Here's how

Featured data: Large nonprofits have more diverse sources of revenue

We surveyed nearly 4,000 U.S.-based nonprofits about where they get their revenue. The smallest nonprofits were significantly less likely to report foundation grants and government funding. By contrast, the largest organizations were more likely to have a diverse funding mix.



Dig into the data

More from Candid insights

Fundraising strategies for every donor, all year round

Giving grew in 2025, but mostly among major donors and large organizations. To reach more supporters, segment your audiences, tailor your fundraising strategies accordingly, don't over-rely on year-end giving campaigns, and make online giving easier.

Explore strategies

New tax rules will cut $5.69 billion a year in giving

The new tax provisions in H.R 1 (the budget reconciliation bill) passed last year could reduce total U.S. giving by about $5.69 billion each year. The gist of it is that a new universal charitable deduction could boost household giving, but added limits on deductions will likely lower household and corporate giving, creating a net loss.

See the changes

Making high-stakes decisions in uncertain times

We're all tired of hearing about "these uncertain times," but the reality is we have to find practical ways to make it through. Learn how leaders at one arts nonprofit made hard calls about which programs to keep running and how to make the most of limited resources.

Get the details

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